



Lingering void: India wears the ODI crown, but the T20 throne remains elusive. For the fifth time, Harmanpreet Kaur leads the charge, chasing history that has long slipped through its grasp. PTI

Plugging gaps, crossing fingers

India's **T20 World Cup squad** has more questions than answers.

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Honesty and transparency are two very different ideals. For the longest time, India's squads for tournament cricket were revealed in statements that left no room for the lingering questions arising from selection calls.

During Neetu David's tenure as chief selector (which concluded in November 2025), much like in the men's setup, the think tank began facing the press when announcing its World Cup squads. Even then, while

there were honest explanations about why certain players made the cut, transparency around those who didn't was lacking.

On the six-month anniversary of India's ODI World Cup triumph, Harmanpreet Kaur sat down with new chief selector Amita Sharma and BCCI secretary Devajit Saikia to unveil the squad that will represent the nation in the T20 World Cup in England next month. A refreshing clarity marked the 20-odd-minute interaction with the press, alongside

a fairly predictable lineup.

Three names dominated the headlines: uncapped pacer Nandni Sharma, the experienced Radha Yadav, and keeper-batter Yastika Bhatia, all handed a seat on the plane to England.

But what did not go unnoticed this time was the glaring hole in the pace-bowling allrounder slot, a role the management has been trying to stabilise since W.V. Raman's tenure as head coach.

Amanjot Kaur, who was part of the